

BODY PROTECTION

Out in space, astronauts are exposed to all kinds of hazards. These include space debris, extreme cold, and lack of air. Inside the spacecraft, astronauts are protected from most of these dangers. However, they must wear special survival suits if they leave their spacecraft to make essential repairs to equipment or when exploring space such as during the Moon landings.

WOW!

Lying in bed for a long time has much the same effect on the body as being completely weightless in space.

In space, astronauts sneeze as much as 30 times an hour.

▲ SPACEWALK

The spacesuit protects the body, while the backpack provides vital air supplies during a spacewalk.



SPACE GYM

Astronauts use special equipment to exercise their bodies in the weightless conditions of space. Exercise helps relieve the effects of blood flowing to the head and gives muscles a workout that prevents them from wasting away through lack of use. This astronaut has his feet secured under straps to stop him from floating upward while exercising.



BACK TO EARTH

Returning to Earth is a strange experience, especially after many days of weightlessness. Weaker muscles and bones make it difficult for an astronaut to walk. In 2003, China's first astronaut Yang Liwei is carried from his spacecraft, as he gets used to the effects of Earth's gravity.

